Ballance Game Design Document

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Gender: Skill and platform puzzle with 3D physics.

Background History: On a floating plane above the atmosphere, an ancient kinetic transport infrastructure has become destabilized. The player embodies the last "Resonance Core", a sphere capable of attuning to the elements to repair energy conduits. The objective is to overcome the labyrinthine circuits of each sector until reaching the final stabilization vortex, restoring the energy flow of the aerial tower.

Mechanics: The player controls a sphere rolling around circuits suspended in the void. Unlike other games, the core and differentiating element lies in the active transformation of the sphere's material. Each material drastically alters power, acceleration and how it reacts with the environment, turning movement and physical puzzle-solving into a challenge of precision and strategy.

The interaction of the core with "State Transformers" scattered throughout the level alters its fundamental physical properties.

The wood sphere is balanced, with medium weight, stable acceleration, and steady friction. It can push medium-sized boxes, climb standard slopes, and briefly roll across certain unstable surfaces.

The stone or rock sphere is heavy with high inertia, slow initial acceleration, and high kinematic momentum. It breaks fragile obstacles, triggers heavy pressure switches, and tilts counterweight bridges, but it collapses fragile platforms and cannot climb steep slopes without prior momentum.

The paper or air sphere is ultralight and agile, with virtually no mass, instant acceleration, and a low maximum impact velocity. It can be lifted by vertical fan drafts and cross ultra-thin rails or delicate suspension bridges without breaking them, though crosswinds easily deflect it and it cannot push heavy objects.

Environment design: The environment features modular platforms, rails suspended in mid-air, narrow tunnels, mechanical gears, and high-altitude ramps. Interactive obstacles and mechanics include counterweight switches requiring specific materials, fans and vertical wind draft tubes, drawbridges, moving gates, and checkpoints that respawn the ball after falling into the void.

Controls and Platforms: The game was planned for both pc and home consoles. For gamepad controls, the left stick provides analog control over rolling direction and force, the right stick controls orbital camera rotation, and the triggers handle braking and fine acceleration adjustment. For keyboard controls, the directional arrow keys or WASD provide directional rolling impulse, the spacebar activates hard braking and stabilization, and the mouse or Q and E keys control camera perspective. For console controls, the right joystick provide directional rolling impulse, the button X or A (depend on the console) activates hard braking and stabilization, and the left joystick or the arrows control camera perspective

User interface: It features a minimalist HUD displaying the active material indicator and physical state, a level timer with a decaying time bonus to encourage replayability, and an accumulated score counter based on collected orbs, crystals, and precision multipliers.

Artistic Style and Music: The visual style follows a minimalist aesthetic, combining materials such as stone, paper, and wood suspended against luminous skies, dynamic cloud banks, and transitions between day and night. Complementing this vision, the soundtrack features an ambient soundscape intertwined with subtle mechanical rhythms. The music reacts dynamically to gameplay, maintaining a serene and focused mood during delicate balancing sections, while building tension through layered acoustic percussion as the ball accelerates or the timer runs low.

Audio and visual effects: Audio and sound design feature material-differentiated acoustics for rolling, sliding, skidding, and heavy ground impacts. These interactions reflect the dull roll of stone, the dry thud of wood, and the faint rustle of paper, enriched by ambient air flowing at high speeds, altitude winds, and generation cues for spawning and checkpoints. The atmosphere is reinforced by a tense yet ambient musical score that dynamically adapts to the ball's velocity. Particle visual effects include friction sparks, dust trails, energy waves during material transmutation, luminous halos at checkpoints, generation bursts when spawning, and active particle effects triggered when moving and catching score points across the track.